

01/ENGL – 2025

English – Solved

SECTION-A (Reading Skill: 10 Marks)

(a) Who is the earliest king of Mewar mentioned in the passage? [1]

Ans: Bappa Rawal.

(b) What was Rana Kumbha's contribution to the glory of Mewar? [2]

Ans: Rana Kumbha gave a new stature to the kingdom through his victories and developmental work; during his reign, literature and art also progressed extraordinarily, and he himself contributed to literature through his own writings.

(c) Describe the life of people of Mewar. [2]

Ans: The life of the people of Mewar was peaceful and prosperous over a long span of time, which is reflected in their flourishing art, literature and their loving, cheerful and liberal nature.

(d) How did the people of Mewar compensate their lack of excellent physique? [2]

Ans: The people of Mewar compensated for their lack of admirable physique through their firm but pleasant nature.

(e) What does the erection of Vijaya Stambha and Kirti Stambha in the same fort signify? [2]

Ans: It signifies the close bond and proximity between the king and his subjects, and reveals how liberal the administration of Mewar was, welcoming artisans from other communities and kingdoms to carry out construction work.

(f) Words meaning: (i) efficient and capable (ii) evidence [1]

Ans: (i) competent (ii) testimony.

SECTION-B (Advanced Writing Skills: 25 Marks)

2. Poster on value of books and good reading habits (50 words) [5]

Ans: A poster titled 'READ TODAY, LEAD TOMORROW!' with slogans such as: 'A book is a friend for life'; 'Read more, worry less'; encouraging students to visit the library daily, borrow books regularly, and make reading a lifelong habit for knowledge and personal growth.

OR: Notice on water supply suspension (50 words) [5]

NOTICE All residents of Prasanti Housing Society are informed that water supply will remain suspended from 10 am to 6 pm on 5th April for cleaning of the water tank. Residents are requested to store sufficient water in advance for the day. Inconvenience is regretted. Janak/Janaki Secretary

3. Report on disaster management talk (100-125 words) [10]

Ans: SCHOOL HOLDS TALK ON DISASTER MANAGEMENT — Keeping in view the frequent occurrence of earthquakes, floods and torrential rains in different parts of the country, our school recently organized a talk on disaster management. The speaker, an expert in the field, explained precautionary measures to be taken by the public, such as identifying safe zones, keeping emergency kits ready and following the 'Drop, Cover, Hold' technique during earthquakes. He also spoke about the government's role in early warning systems and relief operations. Students actively participated by asking questions about safety measures at home and school. The session left students better prepared and aware of how to respond calmly during natural disasters.

OR: Report on bus mishap in Numaligarh (100-125 words) [10]

Ans: BUS MISHAP INJURES SEVERAL IN NUMALIGARH — A major bus accident occurred in Numaligarh yesterday, leaving several passengers seriously injured. According to eyewitnesses, the bus lost control while negotiating a sharp curve and overturned into a roadside ditch. Local residents rushed to the spot and helped pull passengers out of the wreckage before the arrival of ambulances. The injured were rushed to the nearest hospital for

treatment. Fortunately, no lives were lost in the mishap. Police have started an investigation into the cause of the accident, suspected to be over-speeding. Residents have demanded better road safety measures and speed checks on this stretch to prevent such accidents in future.

4. Application with resume for General Manager, Museum [10]

Ans: A formal letter applying for the post of General Manager at the newly established Museum of Indian History and Culture, addressed to the Director, mentioning relevant qualifications and experience in museum management, followed by a detailed resume.

OR: Letter to the editor on garbage disposal [10]

Ans: A formal letter from Kamal/Karabi to the Editor of 'The Assam Tribune' highlighting the importance of proper garbage disposal, describing the problems caused by open dumping, and appealing to city residents and authorities to adopt scientific waste management practices.

SECTION-C (Grammar: 20 Marks)

5. (a) He said to the boys, "Let us start at once, otherwise we may miss the train." [2]

Ans: He proposed to the boys that they should start at once, adding that otherwise they might miss the train.

(b) Bimal told Gopal that he was the first boy in the class and he would remain so till he left the school. [2]

Ans: Bimal said to Gopal, "I am the first boy in the class and I will remain so till I leave the school."

6. Change the voice (any three) [3]

Ans: (a) Summon the fire brigade. → Let the fire brigade be summoned. (b) Sita always plays the sitar. → The sitar is always played by Sita. (d) The team is developing the software. → The software is being developed by the team.

7. Correct verb forms (any five) [5]

Ans: (a) Most of the people in India believe in God. (b) We two have been friends for ages. (c) When he started for office, it was still raining. (d) Hurry up, the taxi is waiting. (e) If you had requested him, he would have helped you.

8. Fill in with appropriate prepositions (any four) [4]

Ans: (a) Your story is devoid of truth. (b) Hydrogen combines with oxygen to form water. (c) Prof. Singh delivered a lecture on nuclear fusion. (d) He has been ill for the last three years.

9. Sentence transformation (any four) [4]

Ans: (a) Can anyone take failure with an easy mind? → No one can take failure with an easy mind. (Assertive) (d) Platinum is more valuable than gold. → Gold is not as valuable as platinum. (Positive) (e) Everybody loves flowers. → Who does not love flowers? (Interrogative) (f) It is a matter of joy that we won the Champions Trophy. → How joyful it is that we won the Champions Trophy! (Exclamatory)

SECTION-D (Textbooks: 45 Marks)

10.(A) 'My Mother at Sixty-Six' extract

Ans: (a) After the security check, the poet looked again at her mother, who appeared wan and pale. (b) She compared her mother's face to a late winter's moon because it looked pale, bloodless and faint, like the fading light of a winter moon, symbolizing her mother's old age and nearness to death. (c) Her childhood's fear is the fear of losing her mother.

OR (B) 'Keeping Quiet' extract

Ans: (a) The name of the poet is Pablo Neruda. (b) The poet says 'let's not speak in any language' because he wants a moment of universal, wordless stillness that transcends linguistic and cultural barriers, uniting all people in shared silence and self-reflection. (c) 'Face of the Earth' means the entire surface of the earth, referring to all human beings and living things upon it.

11. Any three (30-40 words) [6]

Ans: (i) The young trees are described as 'sprinting' to convey their vigorous, rapid growth and youthful energy, personified as though racing forward, contrasting with the poet's ageing mother. (ii) Instead of wars, the poet suggests stillness, introspection and simply walking together peacefully in the shade, doing nothing, as an alternative to violent, destructive activity. (iii) The poet uses the image of the sun and seeds threatened by the earth's sudden quietness to describe the strange, unfamiliar beauty of a world momentarily at rest. (iv) 'Grandeur' is associated with the 'mighty dead' because their heroic deeds live on gloriously through legends and tales, becoming an endless, immortal source of inspiration and joy for humanity.

12. Any five (1 mark each)

Ans: (a) Firozabad is famous for its glass bangle-making industry. (b) The messenger brought word that the general would send a boat that night to secretly remove the wounded prisoner. (c) Many lawyers and peasants of Champaran were ready to follow Gandhi into jail. (d) Mukesh's dream was to become a motor mechanic and learn to drive cars. (e) Mahseers are a species of large freshwater fish found in rivers like the Brahmaputra. (f) Geoff's younger brother is referred to as Derek in the story. (g) 'Gawky' means awkward or clumsy in appearance/movement. (h) The North Bank was 'delightful' during the dry winter months.

13. Any five (30-40 words each) [10]

Ans: (a) Franz's remark 'Will they make them sing in German, even the pigeons?' reflects his ironic realization of how completely and absurdly German rule would change every aspect of life in Alsace, even things as trivial as birdsong. (b) The bungalow at Gauhati where John Rowntree stayed was a colonial-style house situated by the Brahmaputra, surrounded by a garden, offering a view of the great river and its surrounding wildlife. (c) Gandhiji felt that taking the Champaran case to court was useless because legal victory alone would not free the sharecroppers from their real fear and suffering; true relief needed to come from removing their fear through direct, non-violent resistance. (d) Rajkumar Shukla established his resoluteness by following Gandhi persistently from Lucknow to his ashram in Ahmedabad and then to Calcutta, refusing to give up until Gandhi finally agreed to visit Champaran. (e) Jansie discouraged Sophie's dreams because she felt they were unrealistic fantasies that would only lead to disappointment, believing practical acceptance of their circumstances was wiser.

14.(a) Character sketch of M. Hamel (80-100 words) [5]

Ans: M. Hamel is a dedicated, patriotic French teacher who has taught in the village school for forty years. Though sometimes strict, he reveals deep tenderness and patience on the day of the last lesson, dressed in his best clothes to honour the occasion. He expresses regret over his own past negligence in teaching, as well as the villagers' carelessness in learning French, showing humility and self-awareness. His overwhelming grief at losing the right to teach his language, culminating in his silent, choked farewell writing 'Viva la France' on the blackboard, reveals him as a symbol of love for one's language, culture and homeland.

OR (b) Author's experience of floods on the North Bank [5]

Ans: During the monsoon, the author observed the mighty Brahmaputra swell dramatically, flooding vast stretches of the North Bank. Wild animals such as elephants and deer were seen struggling and swimming across the flooded plains to escape the rising waters, sometimes taking shelter near human settlements. The floods caused widespread damage to crops and homes, forcing many people to relocate temporarily, yet the resilient rural community adapted to this recurring natural cycle. The author's vivid description reflects both the destructive power and the raw natural beauty of the river during this season.

OR (c) Gandhiji's efforts for the Champaran indigo sharecroppers [5]

Ans: Gandhiji arrived in Champaran to investigate the plight of poor indigo sharecroppers who were forced by British landlords to grow indigo on a fixed portion of their land under the exploitative tinkathia system. Despite being ordered to leave by the authorities, he refused, choosing to face trial instead—an act of civil disobedience that stunned officials and won him massive local support. The government eventually withdrew the case and set up a Committee of Inquiry, on which Gandhi himself served, leading to significant relief for the sharecroppers. This marked Gandhi's first major victory in India and established civil disobedience as an effective tool for justice.

15.(a) Why did Dr. Sadao Hoki go to America? (125-150 words) [7]

Ans: Dr. Sadao Hoki went to America to complete his advanced medical and surgical education, studying for several years at an American medical school to specialize in surgery, particularly wound treatment. During his time there, he lived with an American professor's family and fell in love with Hana, a Japanese woman he later married. While

in America, Sadao experienced subtle racial prejudice, sensing that people did not entirely trust him because of his nationality, yet he continued his rigorous studies with dedication. His American training later proved invaluable to his career as a skilled surgeon in Japan. This background also explains his complex, conflicted feelings when he later saves the life of a wounded American soldier who washes up near his home, torn between his humanity as a doctor, his gratitude toward his American mentors, and his loyalty as a Japanese citizen during wartime.

OR (b) Mr. Lamb and Derry's conversation and Derry's change [7]

Ans: (Answer as in the 2020/2022 solutions): through Mr Lamb's warm, accepting attitude and his refusal to treat Derry's scarred face as something shameful, Derry gradually opens up, sheds his self-consciousness, and begins to see life more positively, symbolized by his eventual return to Lamb's garden despite earlier running away in shame.

OR (c) Kati Bihu's significance and celebration [7]

Ans: Kati Bihu, also called Kongali Bihu, is observed in mid-October when the granaries are nearly empty and the paddy is still growing in the fields, making it a period of relative scarcity, hence the name 'Kongali' (poor). Unlike the festive Bohag and Magh Bihus, Kati Bihu is a solemn occasion marked by the lighting of earthen lamps (saki) near the tulsi plant, in paddy fields, and at the household granary to seek divine protection for the crop from natural calamities and evil spirits. Prayers are offered for a good harvest, and rituals like tying banana plants to bamboo poles in fields (akashi banti) are performed to attract blessings. Despite its lack of feasting and celebration compared to other Bihus, Kati Bihu reflects the agrarian society's deep spiritual connection with the paddy crop that sustains their livelihood.

16. Any four (30-40 words each) [8]

Ans: (a) The 'magan' or begging custom of the Kacharis during Bihu involves children and youths going house to house singing traditional songs and collecting alms, food or money, similar to the husori tradition. (b) Derry is a teenage boy with a badly scarred face who enters Mr. Lamb's garden through a gap in the fence while running from village boys who mock him. (c) The Tiger King met his end when a splinter from a wooden toy tiger, given as a gift, pierced his hand; the wound turned septic and led to his death, fulfilling the astrologers' prophecy. (d) Zitkala-Sa felt uncomfortable in the dining room because of the unfamiliar customs—ringing bells, rigid rules and rows of strange chairs—that felt harsh and confusing compared to her native way of life.